

The Anatomy of a Claude Prompt

I want to [TASK] so that [SUCCESS CRITERIA]. First, read these files completely before responding:

```
<!-- Context Files -->
```

[filename.md] — [what it contains] [filename.md] — [what it contains] [filename.md] — [what it contains]

Here is a reference to what I want to achieve:

```
<!-- Reference -->
```

[Upload reference file as markdown, or paste it here] Here's what makes this reference work:

[Paste your reverse-engineered blueprint - the patterns, tone, structure, and rules you extracted from the reference. Format each one as a rule starting with "Always" or "Never."]

Here's what I need for my version:

```
<!-- Success Brief -->
```

SUCCESS BRIEF Type of output + length: [Contract, memo, report, proposal, landing page, post?] Recipient's reaction: [What should they think/feel/do after reading?] Does NOT sound like: [What to avoid - generic AI, too casual, formal, jargon-heavy?] Success means: [They sign? They approve? They reply? They take action?]

```
<!-- Rules -->
```

My context file contains my standards, constraints, landmines, and audience. Read it fully before starting. If you're about to break one of my rules, stop and tell me.

```
<!-- Conversation -->
```

DO NOT start executing yet. Instead, ask me clarifying questions (use 'AskUserQuestion')

tool) so we can refine the approach together step by step.

<!-- Plan -->

Before you write anything, list the 3 rules from my context file that matter most for this task.

<!-- Alignment -->

Then give me your execution plan (5 steps maximum). Only begin work once we've aligned.